

hospitals. Our reforms in the wellness sector are significant, and yes, we intend to compete with Kerala in attracting global wellness and medical tourists.



Beyond tourism, what about rural and interior development? Goa's hinterland is often overlooked, yet it is vital for balanced growth.

We are actively promoting temple tourism and cultural heritage in the interior regions. We have restored significant temples like the Sapta-koteshwar temple and others dating back to the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj era. Beautification projects and infrastructure improvements are underway across rural regions. For instance, the central government has granted ₹90 crore to renovate the historic Shivaji Fort at Farmagudi, and another ₹150 crore is being spent on the Porvorim Town Square project. These initiatives are ensuring that Goa's cultural core gets as much attention as its coast.



Let us talk about Goa's potential in education. Given your state's climate and lifestyle, it seems well suited for academic innovation and remote work.

Absolutely. In addition to Goa University, we already host top institutions like NIT, IIT, BITS Pilani, and Goa Institute of Management. We have also set up the National Forensic Science University, the National Institute of Oceanography, and the International School of Law. After passing the Private University Bill, we have invited three prominent institutions—MIT Pune, Parul University from Gujarat,

chayat in Goa is digitally connected, there are still some pockets where network coverage is weak. But we are addressing it. Under the BharatNet project and other state-led initiatives, we are working to take fiber to every home. The state is part of India's 'Work from Home', 'Work from Beaches' movement.



One unique aspect of Goa's economy is the casino industry. While

the industry with clear boundaries. It is a revenue stream that helps fund development.



Do you think major changes and reforms are needed to fulfill the promise of a Good and Simple Tax?

GST has streamlined the tax structure significantly. Taxation has become simpler and more uniform. Not major reforms, but some revisions are needed. People

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| 95

and Ganpat University, which specialises in AI and marine science—to set up campuses in the state. These institutions are being approved only if they offer cutting-edge disciplines like artificial intelligence, data science, and marine tech. The idea is to make Goa a knowledge economy hub that attracts students and talent not only from India but globally.



While Goa has these institutions, the digital infrastructure seems patchy with mobile connectivity issues. Why is that still a problem?

While every Gram Pan-

it generates revenue and draws tourists, it is also controversial. What is your long-term stance regarding this sector?

Casinos have operated in Goa for over 25 years. We currently have six offshore casinos, and that number is fixed; we are not issuing new licences. As for onshore casinos inside five-star hotels, they are regulated under our tourism policies. Goa is a global tourist destination, and some visitors do seek that entertainment. If such facilities are not available here, they may go to Sri Lanka or other countries. We do not promote gambling, but we do regulate

are demanding some changes, especially in the construction sector. Agriculturists also have some demands. These sectors need attention. I chair the GST Real Estate Committee, so it is already on my radar. We are preparing our recommendations and will soon submit them to the Union Finance Minister. I am also a member of the GST Insurance Committee. These are complicated issues. There are separate committees for real estate, insurance, and agricultural products, and each will submit a report. **BT**

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